



Brain cells for navigation

American researchers have discovered a new type of human brain cells that help in navigating unfamiliar environments. <http://dgit.in/15jdeqt>

New Dragon Age game delayed

Dragon Age: Inquisition, the upcoming Bioware RPG has been delayed so that the developers could add multiple playable races to the game. <http://dgit.in/19IXdCT>



Rahul Mathur

the numbers behind Android and began developing for it as well. Nirmitt exploited his background in Microsoft .Net and developing software for Windows and Windows Mobile to move on to Windows Phone and Windows 8.

Raja and Shanti picked iOS because the iPhone was the first smartphone they used and they “fell in love with it.” They also preferred the iOS audience who were more likely to spend on an app. Rahul saw the potential of Windows Phone and the convergent future that Microsoft has promised with Windows 8 and Windows Phone 8.

On what were the biggest pitfalls of working as an independent developer

All five had different experiences to share from their time as indie developers. For Sreekanth, the biggest drawback is the absence of a team and the relationships you develop when working with a team. Rahul revealed that another drawback of working as a solo developer was that he didn't have a second/third-party whose experience he could count on, especially with respect to things he wasn't so great at like design. Nirmitt pointed to the difficulty in getting freelance projects as an indie developer especially without a strong portfolio and experience, both of which take time to build upon.

Raja and Shanti made an interesting observation about how developers expect their work to end when the app is com-

plete. However, through their experience, they realised that without a marketing plan, their app got lost in the crowd, especially one as huge as the one in the Apple App Store. They stressed on the importance of things like building a dedicated website, creating demo videos of the app, reaching out to review sites and even making the app free for a limited time to generate buzz, in order to get the kind of download numbers that stand out.

On whether life as an independent developer provides financial stability

Sreekanth said that a developer working on services can expect a semblance of financial stability by pursuing multiple projects that can generate consistent cash flow. However, developing products (read: individual apps) is risky and all the developer can hope is for the product to be noticed by a large number of users and generate some cash.

Nirmitt stressed on choosing the right platform to ensure quick monetization for apps. However, where platforms like iOS and Android may seem like they would be easier to make money off, even a burgeoning platform like Windows Phone

could be monetized by someone with patience and a good sense of what works and what doesn't. Raja and Shanti had a similar outlook and revealed that they were making little money before their app was featured by Apple.

Their advice

Sreekanth said that he believes that aspiring developers have a wide gamut of options and it's not necessary for an independent developer to produce their own apps. Instead they could also work as consultants and work on app ideas of other people. He added that while developing apps on your own is a risk, the huge number of smartphone users out there means that there are plenty of investment opportunities and users to target.

Rahul emphasised on the importance of coding and comprehending your own code. He said that every developer should enjoy debugging their apps and pushing them towards perfection. He added that developers should participate in forums and discussions and not be afraid of asking questions, even the simplest ones, in order to improve their own understanding of the field.

Nirmitt's advice to aspiring developers was to start immediately and allot daily time to work on ideas and apps. Like Rahul, he focused on the importance of feedback and the need to open up to suggestions, in order to help to develop confidence in your own work. Raja and Shanti also talked about having confidence in the products you create but to be prepared for the fact that there was no 'easy money' in app development. To garner success, Raja and Shanti said that developers need to be willing work very hard and put maximum effort into every single app they create.

If given the choice, would they work for a development firm or continue as indie developers

Nirmitt, Sreekanth, Raja and Shanti were all happy in their current profiles as independent developers. Nirmitt felt very strongly about the fact that he wouldn't fit into a 9 to 6 job in a development firm. He revealed that he codes during the week-ends and sometimes pulls all-nighters when working on something exciting,

TOTAL ITEMS : 5			
Jean			
ORIGINAL PRICE	DISCOUNT		
\$ 25.00	\$ 12.50		25%
OFFER PRICE	QTY		
\$ 18.75	2		\$ 37.50
Beats Solo HD Headphone			
ORIGINAL PRICE	DISCOUNT		
\$ 199.95	\$ 20.00		10%
OFFER PRICE	QTY		
\$ 179.96	1		\$ 179.96
AppleCare+ for iPhone			
ORIGINAL PRICE	DISCOUNT		
\$ 99.00	NIL		NO OFFER
OFFER PRICE	QTY		
\$ 99.00	1		\$ 99.00
iPhone			
ORIGINAL PRICE	DISCOUNT		
\$ 849.00	NIL		NO
			\$ 85.68
			14
			\$ 1,051.
ON INCLUDE TAX OF 8.875%			
TOTAL DISCOUNT \$ 32.50			